

Tool Build (Instrument + Atmosphere)

Submission — Magnifying Glass

1. Deployed build

Native macOS app, not a web app -- no URL to deploy to. Standalone download instead:

[Magnifying Glass v0.2.0 \(macOS, Apple Silicon\)](#)

Unzip, then open Magnifying Glass.app (unsigned -- right-click, Open).

2. GitHub repository

github.com/kliddle29/Tool-Build-Atmosphere

Clean commit history: app code, prior-assignment docs, then this pass's sketches/reflection/changelog as separate commits.

3. Back-end architecture + atmosphere notes

Full write-up in README.md. Summary: zero network calls, nothing stored, nothing persists between sessions -- the only "API" is macOS's own screen-recording capture, called once per toggle-on. Atmosphere pass: 150ms toggle fade, single teal accent (was a 5-hue rainbow), two-tier not-sensing message (headline + guidance).

4. Screen recording of the core loop (29s)

[core-loop-demo.mov](#)

Reflection

What changed from mechanics to atmosphere, and how did it shift the emotional experience?

Mechanics only cared whether the lens worked, not how it felt to use, so it just snapped on and off instantly, no motion anywhere.

Atmosphere meant going back to decisions I'd already sketched but never actually built: the fade, the color palette, how much the error state should say. The fade is the biggest emotional shift: toggling instantly versus toggling with a 150ms fade doesn't change what the tool does, but it changes whether it feels considered or accidental. Cutting the rainbow edge down to one teal accent mattered more than I expected too. It looked nice, but it also looked like the tool had opinions about how it should present itself, which contradicts the whole point of Instrument Panel: restraint, not personality. The error state got the opposite treatment: it kept its instant timing on purpose, because a permission failure that eases in like everything else stops reading as a failure. The overall shift is small on paper, three CSS and timing changes, but it's the difference between a tool that happens to work and one that was actually finished.